Evaluation Criteria

National Institute of Diabetes and Digestive and Kidney Diseases (NIDDK)

ChemiDoc Go Imaging System with Image Lab Touch Software

The evaluation will be based on the demonstrated capabilities of the prospective Offeror in relation to the needs of the project as set forth in the Statement of Work. The merits of the proposal will be evaluated carefully and will be deemed Acceptable or Unacceptable. The proposal must document the feasibility of successful implementation of the requirements of the Statement of Work. The Offeror must submit information sufficient to evaluate the proposal based on the detailed factors listed below.

The Offeror should note that the evaluation criteria listed in order of importance are:

A. Lowest Price Technically Acceptable (LPTA)

Equipment Specifications:

- Detector type and sensitivity
- Bit depth (minimum 16-bit imaging)
- Dynamic range
- Maximum field of view (full gel and blot coverage)
- Light source type (light emitting diode or laser-based excitation)
- Integrated touchscreen capability
- Standalone operation without external personal computer dependency
- Compatibility with existing validated workflows
- Physical footprint constraints

High-Resolution Back-Illuminated Complementary Metal Oxide Semiconductor Detector

The ChemiDoc Go incorporates a 20.4-megapixel back-illuminated complementary metal oxide semiconductor detector, providing high pixel density and signal-to-noise performance necessary for:
- Small-format gel imaging
- Accurate band densitometry
- Stain-free normalization workflows
- Continuity with previously generated datasets

Alternative systems utilize lower-resolution charge-coupled device sensors or line-scan architectures that do not match current imaging parameters used in validated laboratory standard operating procedures.

Integrated Standalone Touchscreen Operation

The ChemiDoc Go includes a built-in 9.7-inch touchscreen color interface, enabling full standalone operation without the need for an external computer.

This capability is essential to:
- Avoid National Institutes of Health information technology cybersecurity configuration requirements
- Eliminate additional workstation procurement
- Reduce validation burden
- Simplify training and workflow integration

Some competing systems (for example, laser line-scan systems) require external personal computer control, introducing additional information technology and security overhead.

Compatibility with Validated Smart Tray and Stain-Free Workflows

The laboratory has established validated protocols using Bio-Rad stain-free reagents and Smart Tray imaging accessories on an existing Bio-Rad ChemiDoc Touch Imaging System that is outdated and no longer supported by the vendor. Replacement is essential due to the risk of failure of the existing, no longer serviceable system.

Transitioning to another vendor would require:
• Revalidation of standard operating procedures
• Re-optimization of exposure parameters
• Re-establishment of normalization baselines
• Potential interruption of ongoing studies

Compact Benchtop Footprint

The ChemiDoc Go meets the laboratory's designated bench and biosafety cabinet space constraints. Some evaluated systems exceed available footprint or require external hardware components.

Evaluation Criteria		Acceptable	Unacceptable
A. Technical	The equipment/supply/services proposed by the vendor meet(s) the requirements in the SOW		
Summary	**Overall Rating (Overall Risk)**		

C. Cost/Price	1. Offeror (s) will be evaluated based upon LPTA.

Technical Evaluation Rating Definitions

Rating	Definition
Acceptable	Proposal meets requirements and indicates an adequate approach and understanding of the requirements, and risk of unsuccessful performance is no worse than moderate.
Unacceptable	Proposal does not meet requirements of the solicitation, and thus, contains one or more deficiencies, and/or risk of unsuccessful performance is unacceptable.